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Congress of the United States
House of Representatives
Washington, DC 20515
April 18, 2013

Secretary Richard Allan
Department of Conservation and Natural Resources
Rachel Carson State Office Building, 7th Floor
Harrisburg, Pennsylvania 17105

RE: Ohio River Trail Council DCNR Grant Application

Dear Secretary Allan,

I am in receipt of correspondence from the Ohio River Trail Council headquartered in Allegheny County, Pennsylvania. The Council is seeking my support on an application for a DCNR Keystone Recreation and Conservation Grant through the Community Conservation Partnership Program that I ask you promptly consider.

Working to develop a forty-one mile multi-use land and water trail system along the Ohio River and its tributaries, the Ohio River Trail Council is requesting \$200,000 through a DCNR grant to help fund the first phase. I have been informed the first phase will involve designing and constructing the first 2.5 miles of the trail, and that the Council intends to use this particular funding to prepare the engineering specifications and documents that are required to initiate construction for the project on the Ohio River.

The Ohio River Trail greatly benefits the Southwestern Pennsylvania region by providing increased economic and recreational opportunities for communities along the trail. This trail will ultimately connect 27 municipalities, including Moon Township, which I have the privilege of representing as part of Pennsylvania's 18th congressional district.

Once the trail project is completed, it will connect a system of trails connecting Ohio, Pennsylvania, and West Virginia together and provide families from all around the region with a spectacular outdoor recreational area. It is worth noting that in 2012, the Council was awarded \$200,000 from the Department of Transportation for this project. This grant will provide the organization with the funds necessary to bring this project to fruition. I urge you to give this grant application your full and fair consideration. Thank you for your time and attention to this matter.

Sincerely,

Tim Murphy
Member of Congress

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